

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner, SME & Online Banking.*

Positioning, Thirteen years owning regulated digital products end-to-end, from discovery through live operations, with a track record of shipping mobile and web solutions at pace.

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Dear Hiring Team,

The Product Owner for SME & Online Banking role sits at the intersection of the two things I find most demanding in product work: genuine end-to-end accountability across a live digital service, and the organisational complexity of aligning global platform standards with squad-level delivery. That combination is not common in product job descriptions, and it is the environment where I do my best work.

My most directly transferable experience is at EMIL Group, where I inherited an 18-person delivery organisation that was losing senior engineers and client trust simultaneously. I restructured it into three lean squads with clear ownership, brought attrition from near-total to a single departure, and shipped the Claims Center from concept to production inside the same period. The Claims Center is a complex, multi-party workflow product, analogous in structure to SME banking journeys, and getting it live required the same balance of discovery rigour, backlog discipline, and stakeholder management that this role demands. At Scheidt & Bachmann I worked inside a fully SAFe environment with agile release trains and PI planning, moving research results into production across a matrix organisation, the closest structural equivalent to managing dependencies across global platform and local squad layers.

On the customer experience side, the CLINET Platforms role taught me that a backlog cut ruthlessly to the top 10% of features, measured against agreed success criteria, produces better user acceptance than a long list of shipped items. User acceptance at CLINET rose more than fivefold after that cut. I apply the same logic to metrics like CSAT, NPS, and self-service adoption: they are not reporting artefacts, they are the feedback loop that tells you whether the roadmap decision was correct.

I am honest about the gap: I have not owned a live SME banking product inside a licensed bank. My payments experience, building Kvitt from zero through acquisition by Sparkasse into the girocard ecosystem, and my insurance SaaS work at EMIL Group give me regulated, multi-stakeholder product ownership at real scale, but the specific SME banking journey vocabulary is something I would close in the first weeks rather than arrive already knowing. What I bring on day one is the product craft, the delivery discipline, and the people leadership experience to build the team around me while I do.

I would be glad to walk through any of the above in more detail.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
